

Kei Ichikawa

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EDUCATION

Education

2024 – PHD	Ph.D. in Engineering School of Environment and Society, Department of Innovation Science Institute of Science Tokyo (Former Tokyo Institute of Technology) Adviser: Prof. Kazutoshi Sasahara
2022 – 2024 MASTER	M.S. Management of Technology School of Environment and Society, Department of Management of Technology Tokyo Institute of Technology <i>Master thesis:</i> Deepfake Sharing Behaviour with a Focus on Emotional Valence and Cognitive Biases Adviser: Prof. Kazutoshi Sasahara
2023 EXCHANGE	Exchange Programme (one semester) Wee Kim Wee School of Communication and Information Nanyang Technological University (NTU), Singapore <i>Research project:</i> How people's trust in the media changes when they are exposed to deepfakes. Adviser: Prof. Saifuddin Ahmed
2018 – 2020 BACHELOR	B.S. Data Science School of Informatics, Department of Natural Informatics Nagoya University <i>Bachelor thesis:</i> The advancement of three-axis tactile sensors for robots using deep learning methods. Adviser: Prof. Masahiro Ohka

SKILLS

Skills

PROGRAMMING & ALGORITHMS	Python, R, LaTeX, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, Machine & Deep Learning
DATA ANALYSIS & VISUALIZATION	RStudio, Excel, matplotlib, Python (TensorFlow, NumPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn, Keras), statistical analysis
WEB ENGINEERING	Django, AWS, GCP

RESEARCH

Interests

Social Media Analysis
/ Disinformation and Political Behaviour / Polarization
/ Computational Social Science

WORK

Work Experience

2024 – FULL-TIME	Data Scientist · Software Developer Dentsu Digital Inc.
2022 – 2023 INTERN	Corporate Planning Analyst Startbahn, Inc.
2022 – 2023 INTERN	Data Scientist Accenture PLC

LANGUAGES

Languages

ENGLISH	Fluent IELTS 7.0 (2024 / 10)
JAPANESE	Native

RESEARCH

Research Experience

2022 – 2024 TOKYO TECH (MASTER, 2Y)	Deepfake Sharing Behaviour with a Focus on Emotional Valence and Cognitive Biases Examined how emotional valence in AI-generated content (deepfakes) influences their sharing intentions, exploring the impact of altering emotional valence on users' willingness to share.
2023 NTU SINGAPORE (INTERN, 1 SEM)	How deepfakes are perceived in Asian countries Investigated how people's trust in the media changes when they are exposed to deepfakes in seven Asian countries (Singapore, Vietnam, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, China, and the Philippines). Primary focus on generating deepfakes and discussing research design.

HONOURS

Academic
Honours &
Awards

2024	Master Thesis Excellence Presentation Award Tokyo Institute of Technology
2024	Tech Direction Awards — Bronze (R&D / Prototype category) Technical Directors Association
2024	CAMPUS Asia Plus Scholarship A Joint Educational Program of four universities in Japan, China, South Korea and Singapore. ¥100,000 (JPY) per month × 4 months. Tokyo Institute of Technology.

TALKS

Presentations at Conferences

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES (PEER-REVIEWED)

[1]
2024 / 07

The Emotional Levers of AI-generated Content

[Ichikawa, K.](#), Chen, J., Sasahara, K.

Paper presented at the annual meeting of the International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2). Philadelphia, USA.

[2]
2026 / 07

Making Identity Visible: Meme Communication and Intergroup Affect

[Ichikawa, K.](#), Naito, A., Chen, J., Sasahara, K.

Poster presented at the annual meeting of the International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), 28 – 31 July 2026, University of Vermont, Burlington, Vermont, USA.

[3]
2026 / 07

The “Oil Spill” as Dimensionality Reduction? Uncovering the Structural Consolidation of American Lifestyle (2011–2022)

Lu, H.-C., [Ichikawa, K.](#)

Parallel talk presented at the annual meeting of the International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), 28 – 31 July 2026, University of Vermont, Burlington, Vermont, USA.

[4]
2026 / 08

The “Oil Spill” as Dimensionality Reduction? Uncovering the Structural Consolidation of American Lifestyle (2011–2022)

Lu, H.-C., [Ichikawa, K.](#)

Oral presentation at the 121st Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association (ASA), 7 – 11 August 2026, New York City, USA.

INVITED TALK

[1]
2025 / 01

How Emotion Shapes the Sharing of AI-Generated Images: Findings from an Online Experiment

[Ichikawa, K.](#), Chen, J., Sasahara, K.

47th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS-58), 7 – 10 January 2025, Hilton Waikoloa, Big Island, USA.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Papers
(peer-reviewed)

[1]
2025

False Failures, Real Distrust: The Impact of an Infrastructure Failure Deepfake on Government Trust

Ahmed, S., Masood, M., Bee, A., Ichikawa, K.
Frontiers in Psychology

[2]
2025
UNDER
REVIEW

Domain-specific emotional effects of deepfakes on news-sharing behaviour

Ichikawa, K., Chen, J., Sasahara, K.